David Adeshina Arungbemi

I follow what moves me, then test whether it's true. Also writes as Suzume.

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Perceptual geometry of images, in people and models
- Generative image models
- Testing what a trained model has learned
- Images and the brain
- Stories and values

EDUCATION

B.Eng. Computer Engineering, Nile University of Nigeria 2019 – 2024

First Class Honours, CGPA 5.0 / 5.0. Valedictorian and best overall graduate. 90% scholarship. Thesis (group project, three students): a wrist-worn gesture-recognition device using motion sensors. Our approach scored 94.9% on the public 6DMG dataset; retrained on our own device, it reached about 60% with two new users.

PUBLICATIONS

Narrative Transportation and Speciesism in Large Language Models 2026

D. A. Arungbemi. Preprint, not peer-reviewed. Zenodo. doi:10.5281/zenodo.21294610 · PDF

I gave five language models a story about an animal, the same facts written plainly, or an essay arguing for animals. Only the story clearly made their answers more caring toward that animal.

An End to End Wearable Device and System for Indefinite, Continuous, Real Time Gesture Recognition of Directional and Shape-Based Arm Gestures 2025

IEEE Access, vol. 13, pp. 153436–153463. Peer-reviewed. Co-author.
doi:10.1109/ACCESS.2025.3602871

My part: the AI that recognises the gestures, and the interface of the live app people use with it.

FELLOWSHIPS & PROGRAMMES

Research Fellow, MARS 5.0, Cambridge AI Safety Hub 2026 – now

A mentored AI safety research programme. I test whether training a language model on a story changes the values it acts on, comparing each story with the same text rewritten neutrally or with its ending flipped. I design the experiments and datasets, run the training (supervised fine-tuning, distillation, GRPO) on Gemma and Qwen models, and present results to the cohort. Mentor: Elizaveta Tennant (Google DeepMind / UCL).

- **Describing versus using a reasoning process.** I trained a small model on first-person accounts of how it reasons: by projecting a known story onto a new situation (Mark Turner, *The Literary Mind*). It described the process almost every time it was asked and brought that story into its reasoning on about 70% of 2,000 dilemmas, yet its overall decisions barely changed: whether it learned the process or only its words is still open.
- **Looking inside.** I trained a small model on a fable and used a readout of what each layer is disposed to say (Anthropic's Jacobian lens) to look for the fable inside it, though its reasoning never named it. With the fable in context the readout found it plainly; in the trained model the signal for the fable's moral was matched by a control, so it came from the training, not the fable.

Research Fellow, Futurekind Fellowship, Electric Sheep 2026

A 12-week fellowship on AI and animal welfare, where I wrote the preprint above.

Selected, Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute 2026

An interdisciplinary programme on how humans, animals and machines think.

Finalist, MATS

Passed the coding and writing stages to reach the final round of a selective AI safety research programme, in its AI welfare stream.

EXPERIENCE

Co-founder & Lead AI, Gyronics Technologies — Nov 2024 – now

An assistive wearable for accessibility that recognises arm gestures. I designed the device's look in Blender and built its gesture recognition, helped build the tool our team uses to watch participants' gesture data live, and made a view that draws a gesture as the path of a virtual pen.

Research Intern, National Centre for AI and Robotics, Abuja — Feb 2025 – Jan 2026

A live video system that tracks people and objects and maps how near they are to each other, and a robot arm guided only by a camera.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Gestalt — 2026

Can different images add up to the same whole? Very different starting images, optimised for structure, meaning and beauty, converged on almost the same picture, as judged by image models (not yet by people).

Codebook Genome — 2025

A VQ-VAE turns each small image into a sequence of 64 codes, which I read like DNA: as a strand, a grid and a ring, three ways of seeing the same representation.

Aesthetics Optimizer — 2026

Predicting the brain's fMRI response (BOLD5000) to a new image, personalised from a person's ranked image history, with a desktop app that tunes generative art to raise the prediction. The predictions were weak (mean r ≈ 0.08), and the write-up analyses why.

Deterministic Inpainting — 2025

Restoring Symbolist paintings (WikiArt) with 30% of their pixels missing; the model keeps colour and layout, and stays blurry.

SELECTED WRITING

Dream a Better Dream — 2026

Understanding what we see before we can explain it, and what people bring to an AI future.

Sculpting Latent Space: What If AI Could Think in Clay? — 2026

What if people could reshape what a model has learned, one correction at a time, without retraining it?

The Question Was Mine. Everything After That Got Away From Me. — 2026

I set out to build a model that reasons in colour; I trained a small transformer on the palettes of over 2,000 Cubist paintings, and it became something else.

17 articles in all at suzume1.medium.com · generative art at davidadeshinaarungbemi.github.io/images.html

SKILLS

Research	Reading papers, designing and running experiments, evaluating results, writing them up and presenting them; fMRI modelling (public BOLD5000 data)
Models	Fine-tuning small language models (supervised, GRPO) with PyTorch, Hugging Face and Unsloth on RunPod; benchmarks; LLM-as-judge; multi-agent simulations
Building	Python (main) with Claude Code; C++ (ImGui / ImPlot); apps and visualisations in React and Three.js
Design	Wearable device design, data visualisation, Blender, creative coding in Processing